

Chapter 126-2

After one injection of sedative, under normal circumstances, she would wake up after sleeping through the night, but Xu Qingzhu remained unconscious for two days.

A full two days.

She had only woken up last night. After waking up, she was like a wooden, expressionless Barbie doll—her complexion pale as paper, sitting on the hospital bed, her thin frame looking as if a gust of wind could blow her away.

She seemed soulless, not knowing what she was doing, nor knowing where she was.

She didn't ask, didn't speak, and ignored everyone.

Gu Junru tried to communicate with her, but was also shut out.

She was like a solitary island, drifting to the middle of the sea, refusing anyone's approach.

After waking up, she hadn't slept again. She had kept her eyes open from last night until now—the corners of her eyes were red from staying up, yet she still sat there woodenly. When food was brought to her, she would eat; when she needed to use the bathroom, she would go by herself.

Last night at midnight, she couldn't open the bathroom door and got frustrated with herself, squatting on the ground crying in anger.

When Gu Junru heard the sound and entered the room, she found her squatting with her arms wrapped around herself. Even hearing the door open, she had no reaction—just softly sobbing.

In that instant, Gu Junru thought she had returned to over a decade ago, when she first met Xu Qingzhu.

Back then, Xu Qingzhu's condition was also very bad, not much different from now.

Back then, she had to be in the light—she couldn't be in any dark environment at all. At night, the incandescent lamp in her room would be exceptionally bright, so bright it hurt her eyes, but she had to have it that way.

The light was even so glaring that she couldn't sleep.

There couldn't be a single sound near her ears—not even footsteps—otherwise she would curl up on the bed like a bird startled by the mere twang of a bow¹, trembling all over. Even if the sound later disappeared and never came back, she could still tremble the entire night.

Gu Junru had spent a very long time helping her emerge from that state.

The treatment process lasted seven years before she became somewhat like a normal child, helping her reconstruct her worldview.

The treatment of psychological illnesses is an extraordinarily long process.

Almost no one can claim to be one hundred percent cured.

These years, Xu Qingzhu had simply not been triggered again and had avoided those enclosed spaces that frightened her, so she had never relapsed.

But who would have thought...

Gu Junru squatted down and patted her shoulder, gently asking: "Qingzhu, what's wrong?"

Unexpectedly, Xu Qingzhu didn't speak to her. She just turned around again and started working on the door handle. Her hands turning the handle had been rubbed red, yet she still refused to give up.

Gu Junru had wanted to watch her overcome the difficulty on her own, but in the end, she helped open it out of heartache.

Afterward, Xu Qingzhu finished using the bathroom and lay back on the bed, keeping her eyes open, just like that with her eyes open until dawn.

In the entire day, she had only spoken two words in a daze: "Jiejie..."²

Both the Xu family and the Su family learned about what happened to her that day. Su Zhe came to the hospital to visit once, didn't linger around, and went directly to help handle matters on Chen Liuying's side—finding lawyers and collecting evidence, wanting to get Chen Liuying sentenced to life imprisonment.

Meanwhile, Xu Guangyao returned to the company during these days while Xu Qingzhu was incapacitated. He left all the important documents for Xu Qingzhu to review while he handled some trivial matters.

Su Yao and Sheng Linlang met for the first time since Su Yao returned to the country, yet never imagined it would be under such circumstances—with the unconscious Xu Qingzhu still lying on the hospital bed, the two of them looked at each other, wordless.

Afterward, it was Sheng Linlang who spoke first: "Yaoyao, have you been doing well these years?"

That affectionate "Yaoyao," though still carrying some caution, instantly pulled the scene back to those years.

Su Yao's eyes immediately brimmed with tears. "Jie, I've been doing quite well."

Su Yao didn't blame Sheng Linlang either. She held Xu Qingzhu's ice-cold hand, trying to warm it up.

Meanwhile, Sheng Linlang tucked in the corners of Xu Qingzhu's blanket.

But Xu Qingzhu lying on the bed was in a coma and knew nothing of this.

1. "A bird startled by the mere twang of a bow" (驚弓之鳥) - A Chinese idiom referring to someone who has been so traumatized by a frightening experience that they become extremely nervous and jumpy at the slightest thing, like a bird that was once shot at and now panics at just the sound of a bowstring. ↵
2. "Jiejie" (姐姐) - Chinese for "older sister." In this context, Xu Qingzhu is calling out for Liang Shi, whom she called "jiejie" since childhood. ↵